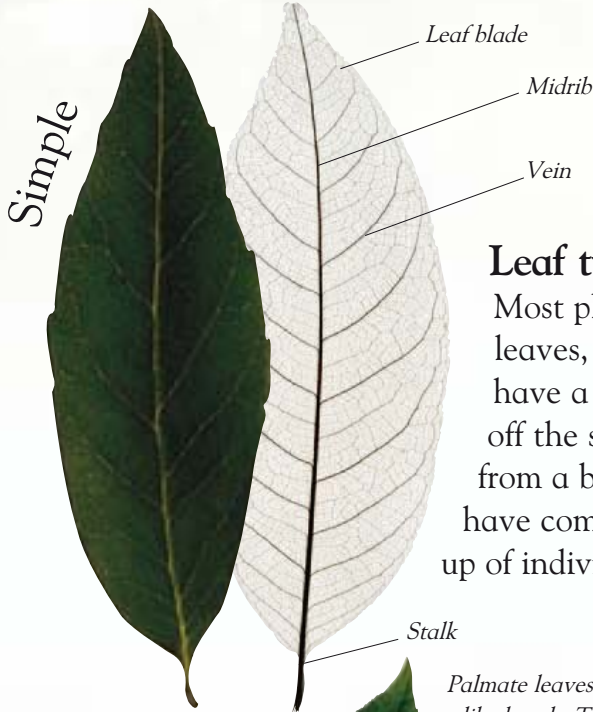


Leaf it out

All leaves are made up of a blade on a stalk, but each different kind has its own shape, colour, and way of growing. This is because plants have leaves that suit the environment in which they grow.



Leaf types

Most plants have simple leaves, which means they have a single blade coming off the stalk. Each leaf grows from a bud. Other plants have compound leaves, made up of individual leaflets.

Palmate leaves look like hands. They can be simple or compound, like this horse chestnut.

Many pine trees grow in cold places. Their needles are thin and pointed to shake off snow.

Leaf facts

- Cactus plants have spines instead of leaves.
- Leaves are covered in wax to stop them drying out in the sunlight and wind.
- Tea is made from the leaves of the tea plant. 500 g (1 lb) of tea leaves can make 300 cups.



Needles



A variegated leaf has spots of different colours, which come from chemicals inside the leaf.

Variegated

